PO Guide Part I · Short Notes ✍️

Part 5: APY · BNPL and COD · Bill Mail · Direct / Media / Business / Logistics Post · e-Payment, e-Post · citizen services (Aadhaar, passport, Jeevan Pramaan, gold bonds) · PLI and RPLI

Yellow = must remember IMP = asked often 📝 PYQ · State-Year = came in a past paper

Atal Pension Yojana (APY)

- Announced in the **2015-16 budget** · run by **PFRDA** through the NPS set-up
- IMP Age **18–40** · **one** account per person · pension amount can be changed **once a year**
- Govt co-contribution: **50% or ₹1000** a year (whichever is lower) → for non-taxpayers who joined 1 June–31 Dec 2015
- Late payment penalty: **₹1 per month** for every ₹100
- Exit at 60 with pension · on death → pension to the spouse → after both, corpus to the nominee
- **No** exit before 60, except on death or terminal illness
- PMJJBY: cover ends at age 55 · even with many accounts, cover limited to ₹2 lakh

For bulk customers

BNPL (Book Now Pay Later)

- Contract customers of Speed Post / Business Post · bulk customer = at least **₹10,000** of Speed Post a month
- Approval: Director / Chief PM in GPOs, Divisional Head elsewhere · registration within **2 days** · below ₹10,000 → CPMG / PMG, 7 days
- Booking at many locations: **₹1 lakh a month** · **National Account Facility**: across circles, **₹1 crore a year**
- 3-year agreement → bank guarantee valid **39 months** · renewed 2 years at a time
- Bill monthly, by the **7th** · pay by the month's last day, or a **12%** penalty

COD (Cash on Delivery)

- Contract customers of Business Parcel, Express Parcel, Speed Post · up to **₹50,000** collected from the addressee
- Insurance **not compulsory** · no coupons / Snowball schemes · delivered to anyone at the address on payment

Bill Mail Service (BMS)

- Bills, account statements · at least **once in 90 days** · at least **5000** articles at a time
- Postage: up to 50 g **₹3** + ₹2 per 50 g · "Bill Mail Service" in bold at the top middle · hand over PIN-sorted
- Within a city / district · adverts allowed, but not a purely publicity item
- **NBMS** (national): anywhere in India · first class, by air

Direct, Media, Business, Logistics Post

- IMP **Direct Post** = **unaddressed** mail (leaflets, brochures, samples, CDs) PYQ · MP 2022 · started **2 June 2005** · at least **1000** · not in letter boxes, in bulk · **5%** discount above ₹0,000
- **Media Post** = advertising through the post (postcards, ILCs, MO forms, mail vans, PO buildings) · apply to the Divisional Head, licence from the Circle Head · aerogrammes in **English only** · 4 colours · min 10 lakh (multi-colour) / 5 lakh (single colour)
- **Business Post** = from mail preparation to delivery (collecting, franking, inserting, sealing) · Business Post Centres · annual reports on cash prepayment (special licence)
- **Logistics Post** = collection → storage → transmission → distribution · **no upper weight limit** · minimum chargeable **50 kg** (multiples of 10 kg) · FTL / LTL · road, rail, air
- Logistics: door to door ₹1 / kg (min ₹100) · airport ₹1 / kg (min ₹50) · unloading free up to 500 kg, then ₹1000 per ton

e-Payment, e-Post, Retail Post

- **e-Payment** = many people paying one organisation (electricity, phone bills, fees, taxes) · **14,000+** POs · to become a biller, apply to the **CPMG** · MIS with 5 fields
- **e-Post** = message over the internet, printed and delivered · retail **₹10 per A4 page** + GST · corporate ₹6 (₹5 for 50+ messages)
- **Retail Post** = third-party services at POs: bills, taxes, forms, railway tickets · network of 1.5 lakh+ POs

Citizen services

Service	Key point
Aadhaar	New enrolment **free** · updates (name, address, photo, fingerprints, iris) for a fee
POPSK (passport)	DOP + Ministry of External Affairs · **429** centres · PCC at **214**
Railway tickets (PRS)	**333** POs, where there's no railway counter
Jeevan Pramaan	Digital life certificate for pensioners, Aadhaar biometrics · **810 HOs** · from **30-06-2015** · at home via IPPB for **₹70**
Gangajal / prasad	Select POs + e-commerce portal · prasad from shrines (Tirupati, Baidyanath Dham etc.)
Rakhi envelope	Non-tearable, waterproof · kit **₹25** · unregistered rakhi mail = first class
Magazine Post	With tracking · from PSOs in 10 cities · pilot 1 March 2022 (Delhi, Mumbai)

Sovereign Gold Bonds (SGB)

- 1 unit = **1 gram** of gold · **2.5%** interest on top of the gold price rise, paid half-yearly
- Tenure **8 years**, exit from the 5th year · min 1 g · max **4 kg** (individual / HUF), 20 kg (trusts)
- Residents of India only · tradable on stock exchanges · **no** capital gains tax on redemption

★ At a glance: services

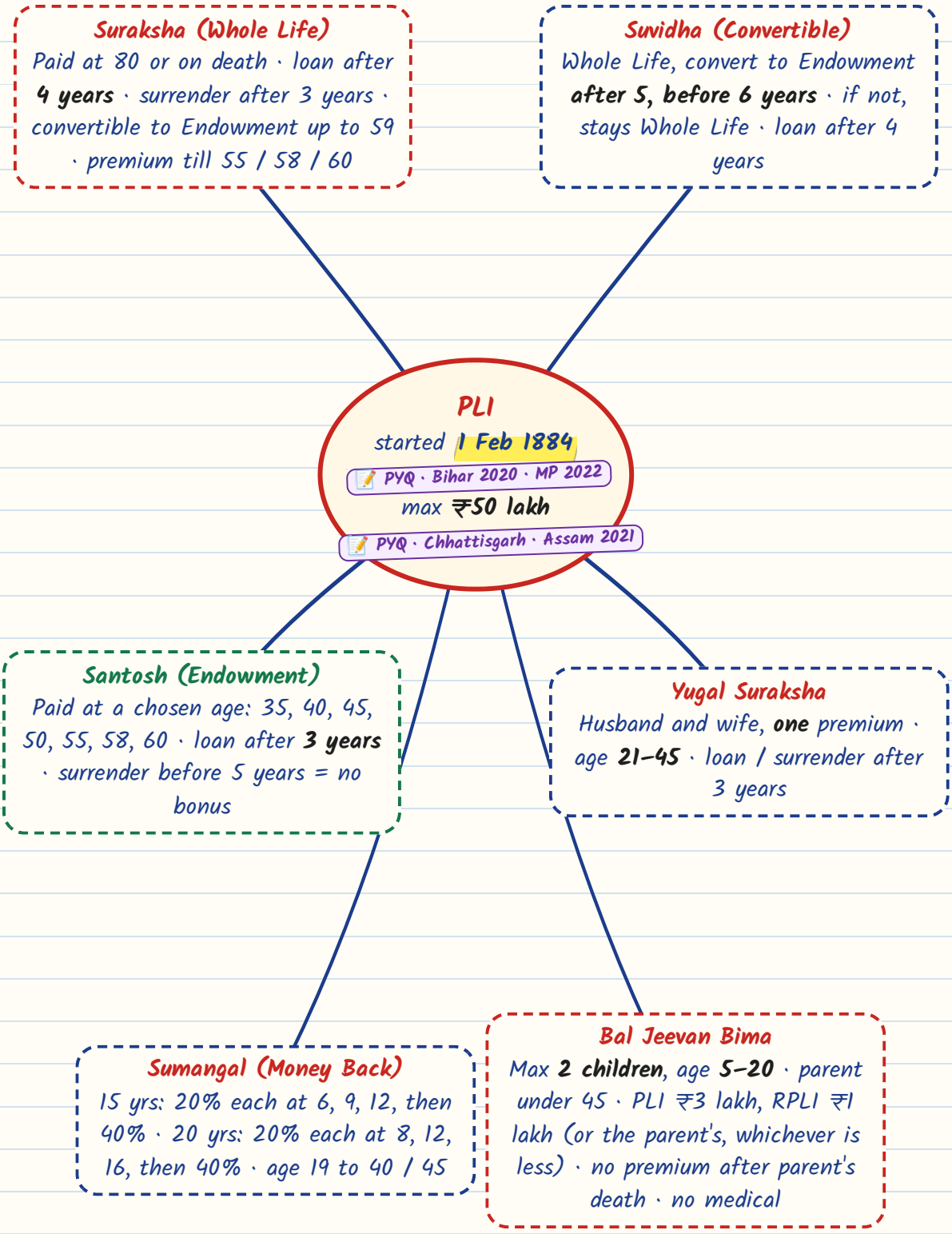
18–40	₹10,000	₹50,000	5000	1000
APY age	BNPL / month	COD limit	Bill Mail min	Direct Post min

429	810
POPSKs	Jeevan Pramaan HOs

⚠ **Exam trap**
Direct Post = **unaddressed** mail, **not** posted in letter boxes.

💡 **Remember**
Logistics = "**minimum 50, maximum none**"

PLI / RPLI · Mind map



PLI and RPLI: other points

- PLI began for postal employees · **1894**: female employees too (when no other insurer covered women) · now central / state govt, defence, PSUs, banks, teachers, doctors, engineers, CAs, lawyers etc.
- IMP **RPLI** started **24.03.1995** · on the **Malhotra Committee** (1993) recommendation PYQ · MP 2022 · then only 22% insured, life insurance = 10% of household savings
- Aim: rural people, weaker sections, rural women workers
- RPLI also has: Gram Suraksha, Gram Suvidha, Gram Santosh, Gram Sumangal (max ₹10 lakh), Bal Jeevan Bima · RPLI (Gram Suraksha) max **₹10 lakh** PYQ · Assam 2022
- **Gram Priya** (RPLI only): **10 years** · 20% at 4 years, 20% at 7, 60% + bonus at 10 · ₹10,000 to ₹10 lakh · no interest on arrears up to 1 year in floods / disasters
- RPLI loan: after 3 years (Endowment) PYQ · Kerala 2021
- PLI money back policy = **Sumangal** PYQ · UP 2020 · farmers are not eligible for PLI (they go under RPLI) PYQ · Delhi 2022 · Bihar 2021

★ At a glance: insurance

1884	1995	₹50 lakh	₹10 lakh	5–20
PLI began	RPLI began	PLI max	RPLI max	Bal Jeevan

21–45
Yugal Suraksha

⚠ **Exam trap**

Whole Life loan after **4 years**, Endowment (Santosh) loan after **3 years**.

💡 **Remember**

PLI names: "**Suraksha-Suvidha-Santosh-Yugal-Sumangal-Bal**" · RPLI adds "Gram" + Gram Priya

✍️ Test yourself

1. Up to what age can one join APY?
2. When did Direct Post start?
3. RPLI came on which committee's advice?
4. Name of the PLI money back policy?
5. Max weight for Logistics Post?
6. Jeevan Pramaan centres are in how many HOs?

Answers: 1 18–40 · 2 2 June 2005 · 3 Malhotra Committee · 4 Sumangal · 5 No limit · 6 810

Source: PO Guide Part I · MTS / Postman notes, pages 109–135, condensed